In this chapter we are going to introduce a problem that seems quite trivial. So trivial that many developers wouldn't even consider it worth a performance analysis, and just implement the obvious solution to it. Nevertheless, if the expression "wolf in sheep's clothing" was to be applied to data structures, then this would be the best heading for this chapter.

We will use a disjoint-set every time that, starting with a set of objects, we would like to account for the partitioning of this set into disjoint groups (i.e. subsets without any element in common between them), for instance: we might start with a list of wines, which would be the starting set, and we partition those wines depending on their flavor, creating a disjoint set where wines with a similar flavor are grouped together, and groups have no intersections with each other. A trivial example of disjoint-set is shown in figure 5.1.

